

HAN YU

Department of Economics
Fogelman College of Business & Economics
University of Memphis, Memphis, TN 38152

Email: hyu5@memphis.edu
Web: hanyuecon.com

October 2026

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Louisiana State University, 2018
M.S. Economics, Louisiana State University, 2016
M.S. Finance, Central University of Finance and Economics, China, 2013
B.S. Information & Computing Science, Suzhou Univ of Sci & Tech, China, 2010

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Associate Professor of Economics, Department of Economics, University of Memphis, July 2026 - present
Assistant Professor of Economics, Department of Economics, University of Memphis, August 2022 - June 2026
Director of the Methodist Le Bonheur Center for Healthcare Economics, University of Memphis, August 2022 - present
Assistant Professor of Finance and Applied Economics, Wright School of Business, Dalton State College, August 2020 - May 2022
Postdoc Research Associate, Private Enterprise Research Center, Texas A&M University, August 2018 - August 2020
Editorial Board, Journal of International Commerce, Economics and Policy, 2019 - 2022

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economics of Education, Health Economics, Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics

Grants

“Racial/Gender Disparities in Early Retirement Decisions During the COVID-19 Pandemic,” (with Grace Arnold and Jhacova Williams), 2024.

- Co-PI
- \$125,000
- Sponsor - Social Security Administration

“Designing A Culturally Tailored Diet Management Application for Type 2 Diabetic Patients,” (with Yafang Li, Pavankumar Mulgund, and Sandra Richardson), 2022.

- Co-PI
- \$2,500
- Sponsor - FedEx Institute of Technology and Division of Research & Innovation at Univ. of Memphis

PUBLICATIONS

“Long-Run Effects of Childhood Exposure to Medical Marijuana Laws on Education and Labor Market Outcomes,” (with Maorui Yang), ***Journal of Labor Research***, 2024, vol. 45, pp. 565-597.

“A Welfare Analysis of Medicaid and Crime,” (with Erkmen G. Aslim and Murat C. Mungan), ***Health Economics***, 2024, vol. 33, pp. 2463-2507.

“The Effect of Public Health Insurance on Criminal Recidivism,” (with Erkmen G. Aslim, Murat C. Mungan, and Carlos I. Navarro), ***Journal of Policy Analysis and Management***, 2022, vol. 41, pp. 45-91.

“Labor Demand Shocks and Earnings and Employment Differentials: Evidence from the U.S. Shale Oil & Gas Boom,” (with Gregory B. Upton), ***Energy Economics***, 2021, vol. 102, 105462.

“Am I the Big Fish? The Effect of Ordinal Rank on Student Academic Performance in Middle School,” ***Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization***, 2020, vol. 176, pp. 18-41.

“Can Superstition Create a Self-Fulfilling Prophecy? School Outcomes of Dragon Children of China,” (with Naci Mocan), ***Journal of Human Capital***, 2020, vol. 14, 485-534, (**Lead article**).

“Income Comparison and Subjective Well-Being: Evidence from Self-Perceived Relative Income Data from China,” ***Eastern Economic Journal***, 2019, vol. 40, 428-462.

“The Impact of Self-Perceived Relative Income on Life Satisfaction: Evidence from British Panel Data,” ***Southern Economic Journal***, 2019, vol. 86, pp. 726-745.

“The Impact of High School Curriculum on Confidence, Academic Success, and Mental and Physical Well-Being of University Students,” (with Naci Mocan), ***Journal of Labor Research***, 2019, vol. 40, pp. 428-462.

“Income Inequality and Financial Reform in Asia: The Role of Human Capital,” (with Jie Li), ***Applied Economics***, 2014, vol. 46, pp. 2920-2935

WORKING PAPERS

“Greater Autonomy, Better Access? The Causal Effect of Physician Associate Scope-of-Practice Expansions on Healthcare Access and Cost Barriers,” (with Tulasiram Nepal)

“Effects of Social Support on Toxicity and Mental Well-Being of Elderly Users in Online Health Communities: An Empirical Study,” (with Eduardo Villacis Calderon, Jie Yan, and Paul Lowry)

“Harmonizing the Yin and Yang: Gender Disparities in Subjective Well-Being after Retirement in China,” (with Erkmen G. Aslim and Shin-Yi Chou), under review.

“Fan Passion and Behavioral Loyalty in Professional Sports: The Role of Social Media Use,” (with Jie Yan, Kirk Wakefield, and Robin Wakefield), under review.

“Falling Behind as Peers Age Up: The Effects of Peer Age on Student Cognitive and Non-Cognitive Outcomes,” (with Chuanyi Guo and Xiao Liu), under review.

SELECTED PRESS COVERAGE OF RESEARCH

The Wall Street Journal, The Economist, Chicago Booth Review, NBER Digest, Bloomberg, Quartz, PressReader, Chinese News Media, The Appeal, The Conversation

Interview with the *National Public Radio*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Health Economics and the Economics of Education, University of Memphis, Spring 2023
- Principles of Microeconomics, University of Memphis, Spring 2023, 2024, Fall 2023
- Principles of Macroeconomics, University of Memphis, Spring 2024
- Applied Statistics, University of Memphis, Fall 2022, 2023, 2024
- Applied Econometrics, Dalton State College, Spring 2021
- Principles of Finance, Dalton State College, Spring 2021
- Intermediate Corporate Finance, Dalton State College, Fall 2020, 2021
- Money and Banking, Dalton State College, Fall 2020, 2021
- Business Statistics, Dalton State College, Fall 2020, 2021
- Microeconomic Theory (Master Program), Texas A&M University, Fall 2019
- Math Camp for Ph.D Students, Louisiana State University, Summer 2017
- Principles of Microeconomics, Louisiana State University, Fall 2015 - 2017
- Principles of Macroeconomics, Louisiana State University, Spring 2016 - 2018
- Economic Principles (Lab), Louisiana State University, 2014 - 2015

REFeree SERVICE

Applied Economics Letters, China Economic Review, Eastern Economic Journal, Economic History Review, Economic Modelling, Economics of Education Review, Empirical Economics, Energy Economics, Health Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Journal of Economic Insight, Journal of Labor Research, Journal of International Commerce, Economics and Policy, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Population Economics, Journal of Public Economics, Justice Evaluation Journal, Oxford Economic Papers, Population Studies, Public Finance Review, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Behavioral Economics, Review of Economics of the Household, Scientific Reports, Social Science & Medicine, Southern Economic Journal, World Bank Working Paper Series

PRESENTATIONS AND CONFERENCES

2024 Peking University - Yale University Summer Camp, Mao Xian, Sichuan, China
2023 Southern Economic Association Annual Conference, New Orleans, LA
2022 University of Memphis, Memphis, TN
2022 University of Texas at Arlington, Arlington, TX
2019 Dalton State College, Dalton, GA

2019 Western Economic Association Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA
2019 Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP), Kansas City, MO
2018 Private Enterprise Research Center, Texas A&M University
2016 Southern Economic Association Annual Conference, Washington D.C
2016 The Study of the Religion, Economics and Culture Workshop, Chapman University, CA
2015 Louisiana State University, Department of Economics, LA

HONORS AND AWARDS

2026 George Johnson Research Fellowship Award, FCBE, University of Memphis, TN
2026 First-Time Principal Investigator Award, University of Memphis, TN
2016 Dean's Awards for Summer Research, Louisiana State University, LA
2016 Grant from the IRES Graduate Student Workshop, Chapman University, CA
2016 Travel Grant, Department of Economics, Louisiana State University, LA
2013 - 2018, Teaching Assistantship, Dept. of Economics, Louisiana State University, LA
2013 - 2014, Graduate School Supplement Awards, Louisiana State University, LA
2014 - 2015, Graduate School Supplement Awards, Louisiana State University, LA
2010, Honorary Title of Excellent Graduate, Suzhou University of Sci and Tech, China
2008, Honorary Title of Outstanding Student, Suzhou University of Sci and Tech, China
2007, Honorary Title of Outstanding Student, Suzhou University of Sci and Tech, China
2008, Excellent Student Scholarship, First Prize, Suzhou Univ of Sci and Tech, China
2007, Excellent Student Scholarship, Special Prize, Suzhou Univ of Sci and Tech, China